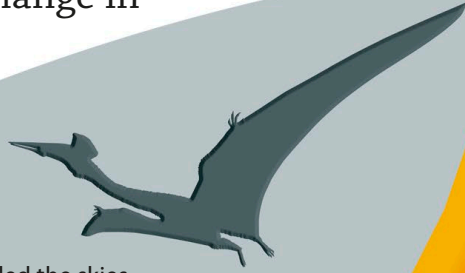


End of the dinosaurs

The age of the dinosaurs came to an explosive end 66 million years ago. Disaster struck when a huge rock from space smashed into planet Earth. At the same time massive volcanic eruptions released poisonous gases into the air. These events caused such an extreme change in the weather that many plants and animals died in one mass extinction.

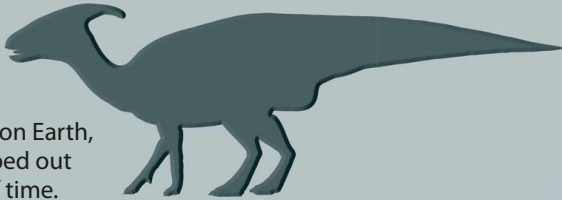
Flying reptiles

Pterosaurs had ruled the skies for millions of years, but not one survived the extinction.



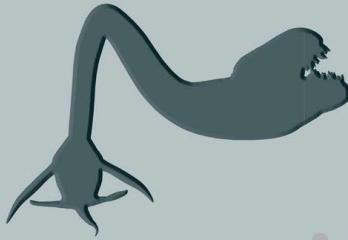
Dinosaurs

After 169 million years on Earth, the dinosaurs were wiped out in a very short space of time. They were badly affected by the cold temperatures.



Marine reptiles

None of the big reptiles that lived in the oceans survived the conditions after the meteorite hit.



Meteorite strikes!

Rocks from space that hit the Earth are called meteorites. Experts believe this meteorite measured a massive 6 miles (10 km) across. As well as killing nearby animals, the dust it caused stopped sunlight reaching the ground, causing the Earth to cool and plants to die.



Who died?

About 70 percent of all life on Earth ended. No animal on land bigger than a dog survived the destruction. Fewer plants meant large herbivores starved and that meant less food for big carnivores.